Go To Bed

By Andy Griffiths

NOTE: Items in ( ) should be presented as an aside to the audience . . .

ANDY: **(Pg 35-52)** I'm lying on the couch reading a book ***(It's really cool. It's about this kid who won't go to bed)*** When Mom comes in and gives me THAT look ***(You know the one)***

MOM: Andy? Did you hear what I said? Put down that book and GO TO BED!

ANDY: But there's no way I'm going to bed. ***(I bet the X-Men don't go to bed at 8:30)*** It's time to stall. It's time to beg.

INTRODUCTION

Bedtime is supposed to be calm and peaceful . . . but clearly no one told Andy. Join me on a rollicking adventure that begins as an innocent moment on the couch but explodes into a full-scale bedtime war. You'll witness desperate negotiations, mysterious illnesses, ghost infestations, legal threats, and a highly dramatic countdown to doom. Now let the show begin!

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ANDY: Can't I say up for just half an hour more? "No!" says Mom, and she points at the door. ***(She thinks that just because she points at the door, I'm going to go through it. Boy, is she in for a surprise)*** Twenty minutes? Ten minutes? Five minutes? One? ***(I've already gained at least a minute, anyway, so I'm already winning, no matter what she says.)*** Please can I stay up? Please can I, Mom?

MOM: Come on. Mom knows best. If you weren't so tired, you wouldn't protest.

ANDY: ***(Mom's argument makes no sense. Because if I argue, it proves, according to her, that I'm tired and I need to go to bed. But if I don't argue, I end up having to go to bed, anyway. What does she think I am? An idiot?)***

MOM: You've had a good time. You've had a big day. Just be a good boy and do what I say.

ANDY: *(stomping his feet and shaking his head)* I am NOT a good boy. I will NOT go to bed! ***(There's no way I'm going to give in. Especially since Dad's not home)*** But then the

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door opens and in walks Dad. ***(Uh-oh)*** He's got a big frown. He looks mad.

DAD: Not in bed yet, Andy? I'll give you to the count of three!"

ANDY: ***(Dad always counts to three. I think that's because it's as high as he can count.)***

DAD: One . . . (stares at Andy) Two . . . THREE!

ANDY: ***(The thing is, when he says "three" he's not kidding around anymore. Better do what he says)*** I leave the room. I count to ten . . . *[Count to ten]* And then I go back in again. ***(You didn't really think I was going to give up that easily, did you?)*** I've lost my pajamas!

I can't find my teddy! ***(I'm just making this up, of course. As if I still need a teddy bear – they're just for babies)*** I'm hungry! I'm thirsty! I'm really not ready! But Mom and Dad ignore what I said.

MOM & DAD: ANDY, JUST GO TO BED!

ANDY: ***(Okay, they asked for it . . .)*** But I've got a sore finger and I've got a sore butt. I've got pains in my legs and my arm has a cut . . . ***(None of this is true – I'm actually 100 percent healthy, but they don't know that)*** Not to mention my lice and my chronic back pain. My cloudy vision! My aching brain! My teeth! My tongue! My eyes! My nose! My tonsils! My kidneys! My stomach! My toes! ***(Actually, the more I think about it, the worse I feel)*** I can't go to sleep. I'll wake up dead!

DAD: You soon will be, if you DON'T go to bed!

ANDY: ***(Did I hear right? Did my dad just give me a death threat?)*** I start to cry. ***(Not real crying. Just pretend)*** I start to moan. *(to Dad)* How would YOU like it up there all alone? How would you like it in your lumpy old bed with the lumps in your pillow sticking into your head? How would you like it if your pajamas were too tight and you had to lie there with a wedgie all night?" ***(I've had these X-Men pajamas since I was four. I've asked Mom for new ones, but she says they don't make them in my size – that they only make them for little kids. I think she's just trying to save money)***

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Now Dad's really mad. He's pretty near blowing. *(to Dad)* All right, I'm going! I'm going!

I climb the stairs toward my room. I open the door ***(With difficulty. There's a huge pile of clothes on the floor)*** and face my doom. I'm all alone. I'm full of fear. It's cold and dark and ghosts live here! ***(The ghosts live in my closet. That's why my clothes are all over the floor. I'm too scared to open it and put them away.)*** A thumping noise! A spooky sound! I turn around and run back down. ***(I want my mommy!)***

Mom looks at me. Dad shakes his head. ***(My mom and dad shake their heads a lot. Especially around bedtime)***

MOM: I thought we told you to GO TO BED!

ANDY: But I'm scared. I heard a thump. It came from the closet. Something went bump! ***(It wasn't the Boogeyman either. He lives under my bed)*** Don't make me go back there! Don't make me stay! It's cruelty to kids! I'll tell the SPCA!" ***(Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Andys)***

But Mom and Dad don't seem too scared. ***(Probably because they've heard this one before)***

MOM & DAD: *(shouting)* WE DON'T CARE,JUST GO TO BED!

ANDY: It's not looking good. They're tough nuts to crack. But I WILL win. I'm NOT going back. I'm going to give it one last try. It's time to pull out My ultimate lie . . . (to parents) But I CAN'T go to bed. I can't go now, I've got homework to do!" ***(Well, actually, it's not a lie. I do have homework, but I have no intention of actually doing it.)***

DAD: It's too late now.

MOM: Yes, it's just too bad!

ANDY: ***(They obviously need a little more persuasion. Well, here it comes . . .)*** *(wailing)* But if I don't do it, I'm doomed! I'm going to fail!" ***(Mom and Dad hate it when I say the F-word)*** I'll be expelled! I'll be out on the street. Who knows what thugs I'm

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likely to meet? I'll join a gang! I'll commit a crime! ***(Not just walking when the sign says DON'T WALK, either. I mean a really bad crime. Like running across the road without even looking. And going to bed without brushing my teeth. And writing rap songs with lots of swears in them.)*** I'll end up behind bars doing time!

But there isn't a jail that could ever hold me. I'd have to break out! I'd have to bust free! Every cop in the world would be looking for me. A fugitive is what I'd be. ***(They'll probably make a movie about me and everything)*** Hunted like an animal. Public Enemy Number One! Is that what you want for your favorite son?

I pause and wait for my words to sink in***. (They look kind of stunned)*** Have I convinced them? Will I win?

DAD: All right. Perhaps we were wrong. Stay up if you have to. Stay up all night long.

ANDY: ***(Hmmmm. This could be a trick)***

DAD: Just do your homework Just get it all done. We don't want you living a life on the run.

ANDY: ***(No, I don't think it's a trick. They've swallowed my story hook, line and sinker.)*** I look at my dad. I look at my mom. I can't believe they've bought this one. This is amazing!

This is great! I got what I wanted! I'm staying up late! But then Mom and Dad get up out of their chairs, walk out of the room, And start climbing the stairs. ***(Huh?)*** *(calling after parents)* Hey, where are you going?

MOM: We're tired. We're going to bed.

ANDY: ***(She does look tired, actually. So does Dad. It must be awful being that ancient)*** But what about me, here all alone? I'll be all by myself! I'll be all on my own! ***(Parents can be SO selfish.)***

(to parents) You CAN'T go to bed! Not at THIS time of night! You're older than me! ***(It doesn't make sense. The whole point of being a grown-up is that you don't have to go to bed early.)*** It just isn't right!

DAD: *(yawns heartily)* Good night. Don't forget to lock up and switch off the light.

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ANDY: ***(This has never happened before. Never!)*** Hey, wait! . . . . *(to audience)* but they've disappeared. I don't like this -- it feels kind of weird. ***(I mean, what's their problem. Don't they LIKE spending time with me?)*** I'm all alone. I'm full of fear. I sit on the couch. I don't like it here. ***(Not anymore)***

What was that noise? I heard something squeak. ***(No, it didn't come from me. Or my butt)*** Something went bump! Something went creak! It could be a mouse . . . but it might be a bat! ***(A vampire bat that came to suck on my blood. Aaggggghhhh!)*** No, I'm just being silly, it's probably the cat. But what am I thinking? *(shouting in fear)* WE DON'T HAVE A CAT! This is creeping me out!

I try to calm down. I turn on the TV. But the first thing I see is a horror movie. ***(Normally, I love horror movies, but it's not what I need right now)*** The living room fills with horrible shrieks! It's a film about ax-wielding blood-sucking freaks.

I get up from the couch Like a rocket I zoom – I shoot up the stairs and into my room!

Before I know it I'm cozy and calm with my favorite old teddy snuggled under my arm. ***(All right, I admit it. I DO have a teddy bear. In fact, I have a few. And I like to cuddle them in bed. So what? I bet you would too if you had ghosts in your closet)*** I pull the blanket up to my chin. I'm safe and I'm warm and I'm all tucked in. ***(Sure, I know I didn't want to go to bed before, but I've changed my mind, okay?)***

Yes . . . I know I'm in bed. But just you wait . . . Tomorrow I'll stay up REALLY late! ***(Good night)***

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